

2026

English — Grade 6

Specimen Paper 2 of 4

Time allowed: 1 hour 45 minutes

Total marks: **100**

Index Number: _____

Name: _____

Class: _____

INSTRUCTIONS TO CANDIDATES

1. This paper contains **9 questions**.
2. Write your Index Number in the space provided above.
3. Answer **all** questions.
4. Write your answers clearly in the spaces provided.
5. You may not use red, green or black ink.

[illegible]

Question 1 — Sentence Matching (5 marks)

Match each sentence on the left with the most suitable sentence on the right. An example is given. There is **one extra sentence** on the right that you will not use.

Example: It was a very hot summer day. •

• *We all drank lots of cold water.*

(i) The old fort had not been used for many years. •

• **A.** Its walls were cracked and covered in vines.

(ii) The museum was very crowded that afternoon. •

• **B.** There was an important exhibition on.

(iii) The children visited a sugar cane factory. •

• **C.** They learned how sugar is made from cane.

(iv) The fishermen set off before sunrise. •

• **D.** They wanted to catch fish before the heat came.

(v) The traditional dancers wore bright colourful costumes. •

• **E.** It was a cultural festival in the village.

• **F.** The storm at sea was very dangerous.

Write the correct letter in each box:

(i) (ii) (iii) (iv) (v)

Question 2 — Grammar (10 marks)

Circle the letter which shows the correct answer.

Example: Yesterday, the class to the museum.

A goes

(B) went

C is going

D will go

1. We like to play football recess.

A at

B during

C in

D on

2. I saw uncle standing near the gate.

A me

B my

(v) People go there to catch a plane. A _ _ _ _ _

Question 3B — Vocabulary (5 marks)

Circle the letter which shows the correct word to complete each sentence.

1. The stitched the torn part of my school bag.

A plumber

B baker

C tailor

D driver

2. The pupils visited the to see the big ships arriving from the sea.

A stadium

B harbour

C zoo

D museum

3. Our grandparents always us a bedtime story on Fridays.

A say

B speak

C talk

D tell

4. The chef wore a white to keep his clothes clean while cooking.

A skirt

B raincoat

C apron

D towel

5. The passengers heard the loud of the ambulance coming from far away.

A music

B siren

C trumpet

D whistle

Question 4A — Reading Comprehension: Informational Text (10 marks)

Read the text below, then complete the sentences that follow.

The Aapravasi Ghat

The Aapravasi Ghat is a small but very significant historical site located on the waterfront of Port Louis, the capital city of Mauritius. It was built by the British government in 1849 to receive workers who came from India. These workers were called “indentured labourers” — men and women who had signed contracts to work on the sugar cane plantations of Mauritius in exchange for a small wage and accommodation.

Between 1834 and 1924, more than half a million Indian workers arrived through the Aapravasi Ghat. They came from different parts of India, including Bihar, Madras and Bengal. The sea journey to Mauritius was long and difficult, often lasting several weeks. Upon arrival, workers were examined by doctors and registered before being sent to plantations across the island.

Life for the indentured labourers was very hard. They worked long hours in the sugar cane fields under the hot sun. They lived in simple barracks near the plantations. Many workers fell ill and missed their families deeply. However, over generations, they and their descendants became an important and valued part of Mauritian society, enriching the culture, food, music and traditions of the island.

In 2006, the Aapravasi Ghat was inscribed as a UNESCO World Heritage Site, recognising its importance as a site of human migration and labour history. Today it is open to visitors and serves as a powerful reminder of the courage and sacrifice of the indentured labourers — a symbol of Mauritius’s rich and diverse heritage.

Original passage

Based on the text, complete the following.

Example: This text is about: the Aapravasi Ghat

1. Where the Aapravasi Ghat is located: _____
2. Year the Aapravasi Ghat was built: _____
3. What indentured labourers received in exchange for their work: _____

4. Period during which workers arrived through the Ghat: _____
5. Total number of workers who came through the Aapravasi Ghat: _____
6. One part of India from where workers came: _____
7. One hardship workers faced on arrival: _____
8. One way the labourers enriched Mauritian life: _____
9. Year the site became a UNESCO World Heritage Site: _____
10. What the Aapravasi Ghat is a symbol of today: _____

Question 4B — Reading Comprehension: Narrative (15 marks)

Anita and the Old Chest

Anita had always been a curious girl who loved history. One afternoon, while helping her grandmother clear out the attic, she discovered an old wooden chest hidden behind a dusty wardrobe. It was locked, but Grandmother produced a small brass key from her jewellery box.

Inside the chest, they found faded photographs, a bundle of handwritten letters tied with string, and a folded piece of cloth that turned out to be an old Indian saree, intricately embroidered with gold thread.

“This belonged to your great-great-grandmother,” said Grandmother softly, holding up the saree. “She brought it from India over a hundred years ago when she came as an indentured labourer.”

Anita listened in silence as her grandmother told the full story. She learned that their ancestor had left her family behind and sailed across the ocean on a crowded ship, hoping for a better life. She had worked hard on the sugar cane fields for many years before eventually owning a small plot of land.

“She was a very brave woman,” said Anita quietly.

“Yes,” said Grandmother. “And everything we have today is because of her courage.”

Anita carefully folded the saree and placed it back in the chest. She decided she would research her family’s history and write it all down in a notebook, so that her own children would one day know where they came from and feel proud of their heritage.

That evening, she began writing. The first line was: “My great-great-grandmother was a hero.”

Original passage

1. Indicate whether each statement is True or False. Tick (✓) the correct box.

[3]

Statement	True	False
(i) Anita found the chest in the garden.	☐	☐
(ii) The chest was locked when they found it.	☐	☐
(iii) The saree had belonged to Anita's grandmother.	☐	☐

Circle the letter of the correct answer.

2. What did Anita find inside the chest?

[1]

A Books and coins

B Photos, letters and a saree

C Toys and old clothes

D Money and jewellery

3. The word "intricately" (paragraph 2) means the embroidery was done ...

[1]

A simply and quickly

B cheaply and carelessly

C with very fine and detailed work

D very roughly

4. What did Anita decide to do at the end of the story?

[1]

A Sell the saree

B Give the chest to a museum

C Write down her family's history

D Visit India

5. The best title for this story is ...

[1]

A A Grandmother's Secret

B Anita Goes to the Attic

C The Chest of Courage

D An Ordinary Afternoon

Answer the following questions based on the text.

6. Name THREE things that were found inside the chest.

[1]

7. What did Anita's ancestor do in Mauritius before she eventually owned her own land?

[1]

8. How do you know that Grandmother felt emotional while telling the story? Give ONE piece of evidence from the text.

[1]

9. Circle **TWO** words from the list below that best describe Anita.

[2]

greedy lazy curious selfish thoughtful careless

10. Put these events in the correct order. Number them 1–5. The first one has been done for you.

[3]

1

Anita helped her grandmother clear the attic.

Anita wrote the first line in her notebook.

Grandmother unlocked the chest with a brass key.

Grandmother told the story of the indentured labourer.

Anita carefully folded the saree and placed it back.

Question 5 — Sentence Writing (10 marks)

- (i) **Separating the words:**
Myfatherdrivesawwhitecar.

[1]

- (ii) **Removing the extra word:**
My mother has always been a very the kind person.

[1]

- (iii) **Putting the words in order:**
old – we – visited – the – museum

[1]

- (iv) **Putting the adverb 'softly' in the right place:**
Grandmother told the story of their ancestor.

[1]

- (v) **Adding capital letters and full stops:**
anita opened the old chest and found some photographs she was very
curious

[2]

- (vi) **Transforming into INTERROGATIVE form:**
Anita has written about her family history in a notebook.

[2]

- (vii) **Write ONE sentence using these words:**
ancestor – courage – inspire

[2]

Question 6A — Cloze Test: Word Bank (5 marks)

Complete the text by choosing the correct word from the word bank. The first one has been done for you. There is **one extra word** you will not use.

Word Bank: during • golden • heavy • quickly • tired • proud • decided

Each year, during the harvest season, workers cut the _____ sugar
cane in the fields. The bundles were very _____ and hard to carry. The
labourers filled their carts as _____ as possible. By sunset, they were
very _____ but _____ of their day's work.

Question 6B — Cloze Test: Your Own Words (5 marks)

Complete the text by writing **one suitable word** in each blank space.

In the evenings, the labourers would _____ around a fire and share stories from their homeland. Some _____ traditional songs to remind themselves of home. Gradually, they _____ new customs and made _____ with people from different villages. Over the years, they _____ a new life for themselves in Mauritius.

Question 7A — Error Correction (5 marks)

Correct the underlined mistakes. Write the correct word in the bracket. The first one has been done for you.

Last month, our class haved (**had**) a trip to the Aapravasi Ghat in Port Louis. Our teacher teached () us about the history of indentured labour. The guide bringed () us inside to see the exhibition. We look () at old photographs and letters. Before leaving, we buyed () small history booklets from the gift shop.

Question 7B — Word Forms (5 marks)

Fill in each blank using the correct form of the word given in CAPITALS.

The indentured labourers were very _____ (COURAGE) people who
left their homes for a better life. Their journey was a significant _____
(MIGRATE) in world history. Life in the fields was _____ (EXTREME)
hard. Their _____ (PERSIST) helped them survive. Today, Mauritians
are very _____ (PRIDE) of this heritage.

Question 8A — Picture Story (6 marks)

Write **one sentence** for each picture to make a short story. Use the words given.

[Picture 1: Children arrive at a museum entrance; their teacher points to exhibits inside]

last year – museum

[Picture 2: A guide in traditional dress shows the class a large photograph of labourers arriving by ship]

then – explained

[Picture 3: Children each receive a certificate; they smile and look proud]

finally – proud

Question 8B — Sentence Linking (4 marks)

Use the word in brackets to link the two sentences. Make any necessary changes.

Example: Ray loves history. He reads every week. (and) → Ray loves history and he reads every week.

1. Raja loves history. He reads books about Mauritius every week. (**because**)

[1]

2. Mrs Lam is our history teacher. She makes every lesson interesting. (**who**)

[1]

3. The visitors arrived at the museum. The guide greeted them warmly. (**when**)

[1]

4. The exhibition showed old photographs. We learned many new things about our history. (**and**)

[1]

Question 9 — Writing Task (10 marks)

Your school organised a visit to a historical place in Mauritius.

Write a story of about **120 words** about this visit.

The following may help you:

- Where did you go and who was with you?
- What did you see or learn?
- How did you feel during the visit?
- What did you do when you got home?

Mark Scheme — Specimen Paper 2

These suggested answers are a guide only. Accept any reasonable answer showing clear understanding. Apply professional judgement to open-ended responses.

Question 1 — Sentence Matching (5 marks)

Item	Answer
(i)	A — Its walls were cracked and covered in vines.
(ii)	B — There was an important exhibition on.
(iii)	C — They learned how sugar is made from cane.
(iv)	D — They wanted to catch fish before the heat came.
(v)	E — It was a cultural festival in the village.
Extra	F — The storm at sea was very dangerous.

Question 2 — Grammar MCQ (10 marks)

Q	Answer	Q	Answer
1	B — during	6	B — against
2	B — my	7	D — themselves
3	B — many	8	C — brought
4	D — the hottest	9	D — whom
5	D — will have	10	C — Unless

Question 3A — Word Definitions (5 marks)

Item	Answer
(i)	Plate
(ii)	Bank
(iii)	Key
(iv)	Museum
(v)	Airport

Question 3B — Vocabulary MCQ (5 marks)

Q	Answer
1	C — tailor
2	B — harbour
3	D — tell
4	C — apron

Q	Answer
5	B — siren

Question 4A — Informational Text (10 marks)

Q	Answer
1	On the waterfront of Port Louis
2	1849
3	A small wage and accommodation
4	1834 to 1924
5	More than half a million
6	Bihar / Madras / Bengal (any one)
7	Long sea journey / being examined by doctors / working long hours in heat (any one)
8	Culture / food / music / traditions (any one)
9	2006
10	Mauritius's rich and diverse heritage

Question 4B — Narrative Comprehension (15 marks)

Q	Answer	Marks
1(i)	False (it was in the attic)	1
1(ii)	True	1
1(iii)	False (it belonged to her great-great-grandmother)	1
2	B — Photos, letters and a saree	1
3	C — with very fine and detailed work	1
4	C — Write down her family's history	1
5	C — The Chest of Courage	1
6	Faded photographs / handwritten letters / an old Indian saree (all three for 1 mark)	1
7	She worked hard on the sugar cane fields	1
8	She spoke "softly" / she said "everything we have is because of her courage" (1 evidence + 1 explanation)	1
9	curious, thoughtful (both for full marks; accept either for 1 mark)	2
10 (sequence)	1 – Helped grandmother (done) → 2 – Grandmother unlocked chest → 3 – Grandmother told the story → 4 – Anita folded the saree → 5 – Anita wrote first line	3

Question 5 — Sentence Writing (10 marks)

Item	Acceptable Answer	Marks
(i)	My father drives a white car.	1

Item	Acceptable Answer	Marks
(ii)	My mother has always been a very kind person. (remove "the")	1
(iii)	We visited the old museum.	1
(iv)	Grandmother softly told the story of their ancestor.	1
(v)	Anita opened the old chest and found some photographs. She was very curious.	2
(vi)	Has Anita written about her family history in a notebook?	2
(vii)	Any correct sentence using all three words, e.g. "Our brave ancestor inspires us with her courage."	2

Question 6A — Cloze: Word Bank (5 marks)

Blank	Answer
1 (done)	during
2	golden
3	heavy
4	quickly
5	tired
6	proud
Extra (unused)	decided

Question 6B — Cloze: Own Words (5 marks)

Blank	Acceptable Answers
1	gather / sit / meet
2	sang / played / hummed
3	learned / adopted / discovered
4	friends / connections / bonds
5	built / created / made

Question 7A — Error Correction (5 marks)

Error	Correction
haved (done)	had
teached	taught
bringed	brought
look	looked
buyed	bought

Question 7B — Word Forms (5 marks)

Root Word	Correct Form
COURAGE	courageous
MIGRATE	migration
EXTREME	extremely
PERSIST	persistence
PRIDE	proud

Question 8A — Picture Story (6 marks)

Picture	Sample Answer	Marks
1	Last year, our class visited the historical museum in Port Louis.	2
2	Then, a guide in traditional dress explained the history of indentured labourers.	2
3	Finally, we each received a certificate and felt very proud.	2

Question 8B — Sentence Linking (4 marks)

Q	Acceptable Answer
1	Raja reads books about Mauritius every week because he loves history.
2	Mrs Lam, who is our history teacher, makes every lesson interesting.
3	When the visitors arrived at the museum, the guide greeted them warmly.
4	The exhibition showed old photographs and we learned many new things about our history.

Question 9 — Writing Task (10 marks)

Criterion	Marks
Content: addresses prompt using the bullet points as a guide	up to 4
Language: varied vocabulary, correct grammar, accurate spelling	up to 4
Organisation: logical sequence, clear paragraphs	up to 2

Sample answer: Last Friday, our whole class went by bus to visit the Aapravasi Ghat in Port Louis. Our teacher, Mrs Boodhun, told us about the indentured labourers on the way. When we arrived, a kind guide showed us around the old stone building and explained how thousands of workers had passed through those very walls more than a hundred years ago. We saw old photographs and read letters written by real labourers. I felt very moved knowing that my own ancestors might have stood in that same place. When I got home, I told my grandmother everything. She smiled and said our family had indeed come from India long ago. I felt proud of where I come from.